The Life You *Choose*

THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT / PHASE 1

I want to wake with the light in a small house with land, *and work three mornings a week at the bookkeeping I am good at.*

I want two hours outside every day and people close enough to eat with. I want to stop being afraid of January.

Anna · 1 May 2027

01 Picture
20 October 2026

02 Explore
14 March 2027

03 Decide
1 May 2027

WHAT I AM CHOOSING NOW

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor. Go and move.

Nothing I cannot undo until the lights are green: the two client agreements in writing and the dates with Lotte agreed before I give notice, the flat rented out before I sign anything in Portugal, and the €8,000 reserve untouched.

1 year
to test an ordinary life

2
conditions still open

4 May
first action

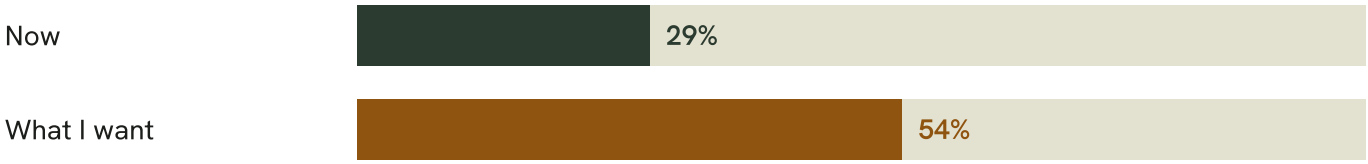
My own answers across the three steps of Phase 1, gathered on one document. It shows what I think today, with the open work visible. It is not advice, and it is not a recommendation to move.

WHAT I AM CHOOSING

Keep the life in the plan

Freedom, Nature, Peace of mind, Health, Family, Simplicity, Independence. The move is only worth it if ordinary days make more room for these.

TIME I DECIDE FOR MYSELF



32 of my 112 waking hours a week are mine to choose today. The second figure is what I am aiming at.

WHAT I NEED / WHAT THE RESEARCH FOUND

Outside space of my own	Yes	Known
Fast, reliable internet	Yes	Estimate
A doctor within 30 minutes	Yes	Known
Reachable from the Netherlands in a day	Yes	Known
Neighbours, not isolation	Partly	Estimate

WHAT I PROTECT / WHAT I ACCEPT

My three clients. My sister. My morning hour. Being able to say exactly what I think.

The car. The storage unit. Half my clothes. The idea that leaving means I failed at staying.

I will know it worked if I am outside two hours a day, if January 2029 does not frighten me, and if someone in the village knows how I take my coffee.

03 / MONEY

What the numbers can carry

Monthly costs €2,360

Income I can count on €1,650

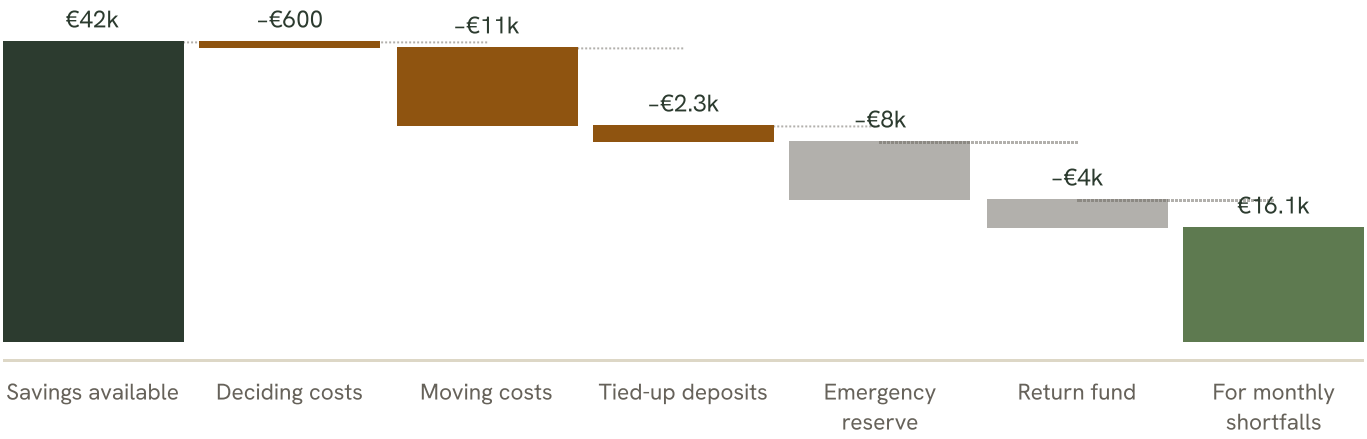
€710

short each month

On the income I can count on today.

Step 1 guessed €2,245 a month. Step 2 found €2,360, 5% more.

HOW €42,000 BECOMES €16,100 TO LIVE ON



22

months at €710 short

18

months I want

If everything costs 30% more: Costs €3,068, short €1,418 a month, and the runway falls to 11 months. That is under the 18 I want, so I would delay by a season and bank the summer work first.

My runway divides the money left to live on (€16,100), not my savings: the reserve and the return fund are kept out of it on purpose. Nothing here is advice; these are my own figures.

MY NEXT CHAPTER

Prepare, check, then commit

Money	Papers	People	Place	Plan B
Amber	Green	Amber	Green	Green
Two remote clients signed, or €200 off the monthly costs	Residency file checked by my lawyer and ready to send	Lotte and I agree the dates I come back each year	The April visit confirmed the house and the village	The flat is rented out for the first year, not sold

The colours are my own answers on the day. Nothing here says that anything is ready.

OPEN CONDITIONS

- **Money** — 30 April 2027
  Two remote clients signed, or €200 off the monthly costs
- **People** — 30 April 2027
  Lotte and I agree the dates I come back each year

MY FIRST ACTION

Sign the twelve-month rental on the house near Góis, now that both client agreements are in writing and the flat is let, before 4 May 2027.

If neither new client had signed by 30 April and the costs had held at €2,360, I would have postponed by six months rather than start on a shrinking runway. The same rule stands for the move itself: a landlord who will not sign twelve months, and I wait.

MY WAY BACK

€4,000 kept apart, which covers the van home and a first month somewhere. Lotte's spare room is where I would land.

I look at this decision again on 1 April 2028, after the first winter. Dealbreakers I carry forward: Somewhere I cannot work because the internet drops. Being more than a day's travel from my sister. A place where I would be the only person for a kilometre.